



MONTHLY UPDATE

Zimbabwe: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-18 · 68 systems and instruments tracked, 9 of them not held

Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-17 – July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.

Summary of the month

The ICT minister launched a whole-of-government resource planning system on 29 July 2026 and committed to an artificial-intelligence ethics framework tabled by the end of the first quarter of 2027, mandated open interface standards for public-sector platforms, and a ring-fenced share of the universal services fund for public-good projects, stating no amount ([launch account](#)).

Two measured positions were published in the same weeks and point in opposite directions. The 2025 household survey put household internet access at 75.5%, up from 50.1% in 2020, and household computer ownership down to 11.2% from 14.2% ([survey account](#)). The central bank reported 511.1 million electronic transactions worth ZiG1.37 trillion in the half year, against a researcher's finding that only about 20,000 cards are in active use ([conference account](#)).

The health minister told the National Assembly on 17 July that more than 400 rural health facilities hold satellite kits that have never been switched on ([National Assembly account](#)).

Infrastructure

Connectivity

Phase 1 of the cross-border fibre corridor from Plumtree to Bulawayo was reported live and carrying traffic on 3 July 2026, at an initial equipped capacity of 800 Gbps on equipment rated above 10 Tbps; phase 2 to Livingstone is due in September 2026 ([corridor account](#)).

The listed infrastructure company reported for the quarter ended May 2026 that it deployed 90 new base stations and reinvested 17% of revenue into capital projects on an undisclosed revenue base ([trading update](#)).

The state fixed operator's chief executive told its annual general meeting on 26 June that government arrears had risen to close to US\$42m, also given as ZiG1.2bn, from US\$19.2m a year earlier ([annual general meeting account](#)). The state mobile operator terminated its chief executive's contract on 4 August following a board resolution ([termination account](#)).

Data Storage

The ICT ministry's 29 July address named a national high-performance computing centre, the state fixed operator and a private operator's data centre — the listed infrastructure company's Harare technology park among them — as the infrastructural spine for future government artificial intelligence ([launch account](#)).

Energy

The listed infrastructure company commenced phase 1 of a 100 MW solar farm for its technology park, and its fuel-management system was credited with reducing energy consumption on tower sites, with no percentage, litre, cost or uptime figure given ([trading update](#)).

Cybersecurity

The national incident response team is named in the ICT ministry's own priority projects and has no completion date or operating status attached. The international project record behind it [carries an empty status field and an achievements field still stating it will be updated on completion](#), for a project that ran from July 2017 to February 2021. What is new is the first-party statement: the [ministry lists establishment of the team among its seven priorities](#), aimed at monitoring, detecting and responding to cyber threats.

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

A whole-of-government enterprise resource planning system, integrating finance, human resources, supply chain and asset management across the public sector, was launched on 29 July 2026 and presented by the ministry as the clean data layer any government artificial intelligence would need; no ministry count, deployment schedule or cost was stated ([launch account](#)). The ministry also committed to mandated open interface standards for public-sector platforms, publishing neither a standard nor a compliance deadline ([launch account](#)).

The online border management system Zimbabwe has been rolling out in phases since January 2025 was examined during a Rwandan immigration delegation's visit to two border posts on 29 July; no port coverage, completion date or throughput figure is published ([visit account](#)).

Digital Identity and CRVS

A deputy registrar general told a meeting of African registrars general on 24 July that electronic passport enrolment centres operate in ten districts, eight provincial centres and one abroad, with seven-day issuance away from the capital ([meeting account](#)).

Digital Payments and Fintech

The road authority took handover of an expanded toll plaza on 29 July with two of six lanes reserved for radio-frequency tag holders, a second plaza due the next day and a third under construction, against a stated programme covering all 29 tollgates; the announcement states nothing on retention, access or legal basis for the movement record the tags generate ([handover account](#)).

The switch operator reported interoperable quick-response payments in rollout and participation in a pan-African settlement system, with no merchant, acceptance-point or transaction count ([conference account](#)).

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

The same registrars-general meeting heard that all ten provinces and 63 districts are computerised for civil registration but only more than 20 of 209 sub-offices ([meeting account](#)).

The transfer of voter registration and roll management from the electoral commission to the registrar-general, begun under the third constitutional amendment, is under way, with no date, transition plan or safeguard stated ([Senate account](#)).

Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

The national electronic medical record reached [1,254 of a planned 1,900 health facilities](#), on a health financing partner's account rather than the ministry's. The [platform's own front page describes it as the national health operating system](#), spanning care-finding, provider verification, medicines and diagnostics directories, virtual care, an assistant and public health notices — run largely without a citizen account and gated by a separate professional-authority check — and carries no facility-coverage figure and no last-updated date of its own. An operator separately reports [more than 20 telehealth centres established](#), company-reported to an anniversary feature with no patient, consultation or availability figure.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

An implementing partner reported on 28 July that it had been building artificial-intelligence competency among research, committee and budget-office staff in Zimbabwe's Parliament, and that staff were using public tools on personal judgment, with limited monitoring of data flows into those platforms and no consistent approach to identifying fabricated output ([partner account](#)).

Rural digital data capture

The ICT minister told the National Assembly on 17 July that the universal services fund currently covers satellite-kit subscriptions only for digital centres and schools, and only for one year ([National Assembly account](#)).

Digitalisation of sub-national government

The base's first evidence on the subnational tier is one council's own statement. Kwekwe City Council [bills rates, refuse, sewerage and water centrally through a municipal resource-planning package, each property carrying a unique account number and tariff code](#), and names information technology and e-governance among its finance department's five key functions. No user count, collection rate or digital-channel adoption figure is published, and nothing establishes the council as representative of other local authorities.

National statistics

The 2025 household survey, released on 20 July, reported household internet access at 75.5% against 50.1% in 2020, mobile handset ownership at 96.4%, and household computer ownership down to 11.2% from 14.2%, at 21.2% urban against 4.7% rural ([survey account](#)).

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

The regulator ran a notice in the press on 26 July setting mandatory data-protection inspections from 1 September 2026, with a registration threshold of 50 data subjects, licence fees in four tiers, a US\$30 application fee, and journalistic, historical and archival processing exempt from the Act but still required to register ([notice account](#)).

The justice minister told the Senate on 23 July that government has begun implementing the third constitutional amendment, transferring voter registration and management of the roll from the electoral commission to the registrar-general, and characterised the 2013 transfer to the commission as a response to legacy issues now considered resolved; no date, transition plan or safeguard was stated ([Senate account](#)).

Strategies, plans and policies

The ICT ministry committed on 29 July to an artificial-intelligence ethics framework tabled by the end of the first quarter of 2027, publishing neither a standard nor a compliance deadline ([launch account](#)).

Regional collaboration

A Rwandan immigration delegation toured two border posts on 29 July under a 2024 bilateral memorandum ([visit account](#)).

Data protection

Certification of every data protection officer is required under the same 26 July notice, at US\$1,250 for a Zimbabwean ([notice account](#)).

Open data

A [national data commons was announced on 4 August](#) for public institutions, industry and researchers to share anonymised datasets, with selected government datasets stated to become publicly accessible within six months. No governing rule, dataset list or portal is held.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

AI

The same 29 July address committed to indigenous-language corpora work led by universities ([launch account](#)).

The listed infrastructure company described its remote monitoring system and digital twin as advancing rather than in production for the quarter ended May 2026 ([trading update](#)).

ICT Industry

The infrastructure company reported [90 new base stations in the quarter to May and 17% of revenue reinvested into capital projects](#), on an undisclosed revenue base — so the ratio cannot be converted to a value.

US / hyperscaler activities

Zimbabwe withdrew from the bilateral health talks, and the dispute over why was settled this month against the templates rather than the parties. Harare's account is that talks ended over long-term United States access to national health data and an attempt to fold in critical minerals; the [embassy stated the conditions were co-investment, financial accountability and specimen sharing during outbreaks, and that assertions it sought Zimbabweans' personal data are categorically false](#). Both are supportable. The [model data-sharing agreement gives the United States secure, uninterrupted access, expressly including login credentials, to seven national health systems for twenty-five years continuing ten years past termination](#) – and in the same clause tells the partner not to provide individual-level or personally identifiable data unless there is no other way. The [template memorandum requires physical specimens and related genetic sequence data of pathogens with epidemic potential within five days of detection, for twenty-five years](#). Harare is describing standing credentialled access to live systems; Washington is denying transfer of identifiable records. Neither template is the Zimbabwe draft, which was never signed and does not exist as a public document. [About 1.2m people on United States-supported HIV treatment face wind-down](#).

Inclusion and capacity

Digital divides

The 2025 household survey puts [household internet access at 75.5% and mobile handset ownership at 96.4%, rural 94.5% against urban 99.2%](#). Computer ownership is the divide the handset figures conceal: [11.2% of households, urban 21.2% against rural 4.7%](#). The two measures are five years apart and the intervening trend is not held.

Access to services

The health minister told the National Assembly on 17 July that more than 400 health facilities had received satellite kits with 300 more to be added, but that subscriptions had not been paid because the fees were too high ([National Assembly account](#)).

At a payments conference on 24 July a research firm reported that 95% of transport payments remain cash, that 56% of respondents found digital systems complicated with people with disabilities particularly affected ([conference account](#)).

Training and skills

The ICT minister told a small-business meeting on 17 July that a digital skills programme targets 1.5 million people ([meeting account](#)).

Finance

New investments

The ICT minister also committed on 29 July to ring-fencing a share of the universal services fund for public-good artificial-intelligence projects, stating no amount ([launch account](#)).

Two external commitments arrived in August, and only one of them has a number attached to Zimbabwe. A United Nations contract award of 10 August [puts US\\$5,947,948 into the supply of ICT equipment to the country](#) — an exact figure against a purpose stated as nothing more than ICT equipment, with neither the receiving government body nor the awarded vendor named. The United Kingdom separately [opened expressions of interest for a Southern Africa science and technology accelerator worth up to GBP2.5m to March 2030](#), naming Zimbabwe and Zambia as its first year's focus with South Africa the primary one. No Zimbabwean allocation is stated and no delivery consortium has been chosen.

MoUs and other agreements

The cross-border fibre corridor from Plumtree to Bulawayo runs under a public-private partnership signed in June 2025; no investment amount was disclosed by either party ([corridor account](#)).

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